

The Capitals rally past the Canadiens with a big third period to grab a 3-1 series lead. D1

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

SU V1 V2 V3 V4



Mostly sunny 76/54 • Tomorrow: Mostly cloudy 84/67 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

MONDAY, APRIL 28, 2025 • \$4

Justices consider landmark school case

Allowing religious public schools would remake constitutional principles

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL
AND LAURA MECKLER

The proposal was the most audacious Robert Franklin had seen during his four decades in education: The Catholic Archdiocese of Oklahoma City wanted to create the nation's first religious, taxpayer-funded public charter school.

Franklin, who chaired a state board responsible for approving new charter schools, saw the idea as patently illegal and an obvious assault on the separation of church and state. Oklahoma would be directly sponsoring — and paying for — a school that promises to inject religion into every aspect of its teaching and expect students “to adhere” to its beliefs.

He was sure the idea would quickly die.

But this was a proposal aimed well beyond one tiny charter school for rural Oklahoma. It was part of a careful legal and political strategy aimed at affecting public and parochial education coast to coast.

During a break in a meeting of the charter school board where the proposal was discussed, Franklin approached a church official who had helped craft the idea.

“I feel like this is so much bigger than what this board is all about,” Franklin told him. “Perhaps I’m just a pawn in this process.”

“You are,” the official replied, according to Franklin. “We’re going forward. We will go to the Supreme Court if we have to.”

SEE SUPREME COURT ON A8



CAROLYN VAN HOUTEN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Alaska's St. Paul Island has been ravaged by climate change, and many residents are weighing how long they can remain there.

As Bering Sea ice vanishes, upheaval hits a remote island

Warming waters, a shuttered crab processing plant and a fraying Alaska community

BY JOSHUA PARTLOW AND CAROLYN VAN HOUTEN

ST. PAUL ISLAND, ALASKA — This tiny island in the middle of the Bering Sea had recently completed its longest winter stretch in recorded history with above-freezing temperatures — 343 consecutive hours, or 14 days — when Aaron Lestenkof drove out to look at Sea Lion Neck.

It was another warm February day. He saw no sea ice; scant snow on the ground.

Lestenkof is one of the sentinels on the island, a small team with the Aleut tribe who monitors changes to the environment across these 43 square miles of windswept hills and tundra. He is also one of 338 residents who still manage to live on St. Paul, something that has become significantly more complicated as the Bering Sea warms around them.

Over the past decade, steadily warming waters have thrown the North Pacific into turmoil, wiping out popula-

tions of fish, birds and crabs, and exposing coastlines to ever more battering from winter storms. The upheaval in the waters has brought so much change to this remote island, where residents still fill their freezers with reindeer and seals, that it has forced many to consider how long they can last.

The warm waters killed off about 4 million common murrelets — the largest die-off of any bird species ever recorded in the modern era — including almost 80 percent of those that nested on St. Paul. They wiped out about 10 billion snow crabs; caused the collapse of the main Alaskan fishery that relied on them; and prompted the closing, three years ago, of St. Paul's largest source of tax revenue, a Trident Seafoods crab processing plant.

SEE BERING SEA ON A6

Tariffs already affecting economy

TRUMP SOFTENS TOUGH TRADE TALK

Changes begin to disrupt supply chains, pricing

BY DAVID J. LYNCH
AND JEFF STEIN

With 14 months remaining before the United States' 250th birthday on July 4, 2026, Stacy Blake should be placing big orders with the Chinese factories that supply her fireworks company in St. Joseph, Missouri. But she's not. And she blames President Donald Trump's tariffs.

The same president who's making plans for a “grand celebration” of this national milestone has imposed sky-high import duties that will make that star-spangled festival tough to pull off.

With the trade war causing U.S. orders to dry up, Chinese fireworks factories have begun shutting down. That threatens to disrupt the industry's production schedule, leading to serious shortages, said Blake, co-owner of Schneitter Fireworks & Importing.

“We’ve got a huge problem ahead of us going into next year,” said Blake, who is also president of the National Fireworks Association. “This season is when Chinese manufacturers would be manufacturing our products right now for 2026, for the 250th. Very little production is happening. They have halted it.”

The fireworks disruption looms even though the president spent much of last week softening his tariff rhetoric. He said that “a fair deal” with China was possible and

SEE TRUMP ON A4

Many Jews say Trump hurting fight against hatred

Some support combating antisemitism but feel his approach could backfire

BY NAFTALI BENDAVID

The Trump administration declared April 14 that “harassment of Jewish students is intolerable” as it suspended \$2.2 billion in grants to Harvard University. The school's president, Alan Garber, fired back April 21 that “as a Jew and as an American,” he is well aware of the rising antisemitism but that de-

funding Harvard is no solution.

The Trump administration has frequently cited antisemitism to justify its decisions to slash funding for elite universities, deport foreign students it accuses of anti-Jewish sentiment, and seek more control over what American schools and universities teach.

Some Jewish leaders welcome President Donald Trump's efforts as the most aggressive fight against anti-Jewish bigotry in American history. But others worry that Trump is politicizing the fight against antisemitism by using it to promote his agenda — potentially hurting Jews in the long run, especially as Trump dis-

mantles other antidiscrimination efforts.

On the state level, legislators — mostly Republicans — are also pressing ahead with bills that include a much-debated definition of antisemitism, one that critics say chills legitimate criticism of Israel.

The dispute has exacerbated long-running tensions between liberal and conservative Jews, who increasingly diverge in their views of the Israeli government and in some cases Israel itself, as well as which side of the political divide best represents their values and interests.

SEE ANTISEMITISM ON A4



CHARITY RACHELLE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Alex Ford and her daughter Khloe, 4, sort through clothing at the West Alabama Women's Center.

In post-Roe world, clinic is a safety net

Ala. facility offers help to mothers, but Medicaid cuts threaten its services

BY MOLLY HENNESSY-FISCHE

TUSCALOOSA, ALA. — Once, it was the sole abortion clinic in this half of the state. Then *Roe v. Wade* fell, the legislature's near-total ban on the procedure took effect, and the protesters who would mass in the parking lot vanished. Nowadays,

the crowd that gathers when word goes out follows the handwritten signs for “FREE STUFF.”

Under towering pines, the front lawn of the West Alabama Women's Center turns into a rummage bonanza — with baby formula, children's clothes and shoes, toys and other donations spread out on

blankets.

“It's hard to live paycheck to paycheck,” said Keilani Camara, a mother of three from rural Knoxville, as she perused the offerings at the most recent giveaway. Camara works at a trucking company; her husband is unemployed.

SEE CLINIC ON A5

After threat, GWU quietly prepares for the worst

To avoid potentially fatal financial cut, university taking guarded approach

BY DAN ROSENZWEIG-ZIFF

The Trump administration's letter to George Washington University came on Feb. 27.

The school, the administration warned, was one of 10, along with Harvard, Columbia and others, that would be visited for allegedly

failing to protect Jewish community members from unlawful discrimination. The school could face remedial action, the letter said, and the administration intended to meet with the university about its concerns.

Leaders at GWU soon responded, saying they'd participate in any inquiry.

As the institution waited, the Trump administration took action elsewhere: It canceled about \$400 million of funding to Columbia, then targeted Harvard, freezing \$2.2 billion in grants and contracts.

GWU is trying to avoid a similar fate.

University leaders have been meeting regularly to figure out how to respond to action by President Donald Trump, according to four people familiar with the university's planning who spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe sensitive discussions. Previous efforts are finding renewed urgency.

University officials are seeking advice from alumni in the government on how to navigate the administration. They're deploying

SEE GWU ON A5

IN THE NEWS

Removals of children The president's border czar said three young U.S. citizens were sent to Honduras because their mothers, who were being deported, wished to bring them. A2

Commanders stadium D.C. and the franchise are planning to announce a deal to build the team's next home at the RFK Stadium site. D1

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THE REGION
Readers from around the world reflect on Pope Francis's life and leadership. B1

The acting U.S. attorney for D.C. wrote to the nonprofit that runs Wikipedia, accusing it of allowing the spread of “propaganda.” B1
Two people have been arrested in connection with the theft of Homeland Security Secretary Kristi L. Noem's purse, authorities said. B1

STYLE
The White House correspondents' dinner weekend wasn't the high-wattage showing of stars that has captivated the city in years past. C1
The pope's funeral captured a visual and ideological tension within Catholicism, Philip Kennicott writes. C1

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